

Task 1- Configure Local Security Policy

Steps:

- Press Win + R, type:
 - secpol.msc
- Go to:
 - Security Settings
 - Account Policies
 - Password Policy
- Configure:
 - Minimum password length: 8 characters
 - Password must meet complexity requirements: Enabled
 - Maximum password age: 45 days
- Click Apply
 - OK.

Task 2- Enable Windows Defender and Schedule a Daily Quick Scan

Enable Defender

- Open Windows Security.
- Go to Virus & threat protection.
- Click Manage settings.
- Ensure Real-time protection is ON.

Schedule a Daily Quick Scan

- Open Task Scheduler (taskschd.msc).
- Navigate to:
 - Task Scheduler Library
 - Microsoft
 - Windows
 - Windows Defender
- Right-click Windows Defender Scheduled Scan
 - Properties.
- Under Triggers, create a new trigger:
 - Daily
 - Choose your preferred time (e.g., 9:00 AM)
- Save the settings.

Task 3- Configure Windows Server Backup

Create the Backup

- Open Windows Server Backup.
- Select Local Backup.
- Click Backup Schedule.
- Choose Custom.
- Add the folder:
 - C:\ProjectFiles
- Choose a different drive as the backup destination
- Schedule the backup.
- Finish the wizard.

Task 4- Configure Performance Monitor

- Press Win + R, type:
 - perfmon
- Expand:
 - Data Collector Sets
 - User Defined
- Create a New Data Collector Set.
- Add counters:
 - Processor → % Processor Time
 - Memory → Available MBytes
- Set the collection duration to 30 minutes.
- Start the Data Collector Set.
- After it finishes, export the report as CSV

Task 5- Report

This practical exercise focused on configuring essential security and maintenance features on a Windows Server. A password policy was applied using the Local Security Policy tool to enforce a minimum password length of eight characters, enable password complexity, and require password changes every 45 days. These settings help strengthen authentication and reduce the risk of unauthorized access.

Windows Defender was verified to be active with real-time protection enabled. A daily quick scan was scheduled using Task Scheduler to ensure regular malware detection and system protection.

To improve data protection, Windows Server Backup was configured to create scheduled backups of the ProjectFiles folder to a different storage drive. This helps ensure important files can be recovered in the event of data loss or system failure.

Performance Monitor was configured to track CPU utilization and available memory. A Data Collector Set was created to monitor system performance, and the collected data was exported for review. Monitoring these resources helps identify performance bottlenecks and supports proactive server maintenance.

During the configuration process, the main challenge was verifying that all scheduled tasks and services were running correctly. This was resolved by reviewing Task Scheduler, Windows Server Backup, and Performance Monitor settings. Overall, the implemented security policies, scheduled backups, and performance monitoring contribute to a more secure, reliable, and maintainable Windows Server environment.